



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Annual Exam — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	What are yardangs? (A) Flat surfaces left after finer particles are blown away (B) Shallow depressions formed where loose material is removed (C) Rocks polished and shaped by sandblasting (D) Streamlined rock ridges carved by wind Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Yardangs are streamlined rock ridges carved by wind, formed through wind erosion in arid regions. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
2	What are terminal moraines and where are they found? (A) Moraines found at the end of glaciers, marking their furthest advance (B) Moraines formed along the sides of glaciers (C) Moraines formed when two glaciers meet (D) Moraines formed by wind deposition near glaciers Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Terminal moraines are found at the end of glaciers, marking their furthest advance. They are formed when a glacier melts and deposits the material it has eroded from land. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	Each text of the Veda has how many parts? (A) Two (B) Three (C) Four (D) Five Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Each text of the Veda has four parts: samhitā, brāhmaṇa, āraṇyaka, and upaniṣad. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
4	India's constitutional framework operates through a three-tier system comprising which of the following? (A) Union, State, and Local governments (B) Central, Regional, and District governments (C) National, State, and Village governments (D) Parliament, State Legislature, and Panchayat Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Union, State, and Local governments — India's constitutional framework operates through a three-tier system comprising the Union, State, and Local governments, facilitating administrative efficiency and democratic participation. [Ch 6: Democracy]	1
5	How does the thermosphere assist in radio transmission? (A) It reflects radio waves transmitted from the Earth back towards it (B) It absorbs all radio waves and prevents interference (C) It generates radio waves from solar radiation (D) It contains the ozone layer which boosts signal strength Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The thermosphere helps with radio transmission by reflecting radio waves transmitted from the Earth back towards it. The ionosphere, which is a part of the thermosphere, plays a role in this process. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	1
6	Political parties help ensure that democracy functions effectively by providing which of the following? (A) Governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement (B) Legislation, taxation, defence, and foreign policy (C) Education, healthcare, infrastructure, and employment (D) Censorship, regulation, enforcement, and adjudication Answer: Correct Option: (A)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? A. Political parties help ensure that democracy functions effectively by providing governance, accountability, representation, and public engagement. [Ch 7: Elections]	
7	Which Veda comprises hymns drawn from the Rig Veda, carefully arranged for musical recitation? (A) Yajur Veda (B) Atharva Veda (C) Rig Veda (D) Sāma Veda Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Sāma Veda comprises hymns drawn from the Rig Veda, carefully arranged for musical recitation, and its chanting tradition forms an important foundation for the system of the seven svaras (notes). [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1
8	What does economics essentially deal with? (A) Predicting stock market trends and corporate profits (B) Studying only the history of trade between nations (C) Making choices to use limited resources to satisfy unlimited wants (D) Managing government budgets without considering individual choices Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Economics deals with how individuals and societies make choices to use limited resources to satisfy unlimited wants. Every choice involves an opportunity cost—giving up one option for another. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1
9	If the demand for printers increases, what is likely to happen to the demand for printer cartridges, even if the price of cartridges remains unchanged? (A) Demand for cartridges will fall (B) Demand for cartridges will remain constant (C) Demand for cartridges will rise (D) Demand for cartridges will become zero Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Demand for cartridges will rise, because printers and printer cartridges are complementary goods that are used together, so an increase in demand for one increases demand for the other. [Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
10	Which of the following factors contributes to the occurrence of dust storms? (A) Heavy and continuous rainfall (B) Dense vegetation cover (C) Rapid melting of glaciers (D) Prolonged drought and low rainfall drying out the soil Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Prolonged drought and low rainfall dry out the soil, making it easier for wind to pick up fine particles. Dust storms are common in desert and semi-arid regions where the soil is loose and dry. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
11	Which democratic value is promoted by the Electoral Process through the Election Commission of India? (A) Rule of law and Justice (B) Transparency (C) Devolution of power (D) Participation and Equality Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Electoral Process, supported by the Election Commission of India, promotes the democratic values of Participation and Equality. [Ch 6: Democracy]	1
12	What major shift occurred in India's economic system after 1991? (A) India moved from a market economy to a fully planned economy (B) India shifted towards a more market-oriented system while retaining an important role for the government (C) India completely privatised all public sector companies (D) India stopped all international trade and became self-sufficient Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. By 1991, India faced serious economic difficulties. The government introduced major economic reforms that reduced excessive regulations, encouraged private enterprise, opened the economy to global trade and investment, and increased competition. These reforms gradually shifted India towards a more market-oriented system while still retaining an important role for the government. [Ch 8: Building Blocks in Economics: The Problem of Choice]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
13	What does Economics primarily help us understand? (A) How governments distribute political power among institutions (B) How physical features of the Earth influence human settlements (C) How cultural values are transmitted from one generation to the next (D) How individuals and societies decide how to use limited resources to meet their needs Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Economics helps us understand how individuals and societies decide how to use limited resources to meet their needs, studying how goods and services are produced, exchanged, and distributed. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
14	The concept of Pañchamahābhūtas describes the natural world as an interconnected system. Which of the following does it help explain? (A) The duties of rulers toward their people and taxation systems (B) The interconnectedness of human societies across regions and cultures (C) How the environment influences settlement patterns, occupations, architecture, food habits, and health practices (D) How markets and prices function in a modern economy Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The Pañchamahābhūtas describes the natural world as an interconnected system in which human life is embedded, helping explain how the environment influences settlement patterns, occupations, architecture, food habits, and health practices. <i>[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]</i>	1
15	Which two gases are the primary and most abundant gases in the Earth's atmosphere? (A) Carbon dioxide and oxygen (B) Nitrogen and carbon dioxide (C) Nitrogen and oxygen (D) Oxygen and hydrogen Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Nitrogen and oxygen are the two primary and most abundant gases in the atmosphere that are essential to life on Earth. <i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	1
16	What does the Egyptian calendar's season 'Peret' refer to? (A) Harvest (summer) (B) Inundation (autumn) (C) Growing (winter) (D) Drying (spring)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Growing (winter), because the Egyptian calendar had three seasons: Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and shemu harvest (summer). [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
17	A drought affects crops, farmers' incomes, government relief measures, migration to cities, and traditional ways of coping with scarcity. What does this example illustrate about Social Science? (A) That only Economics can fully explain the impact of natural disasters (B) That no single field of study can fully explain human society, requiring multiple disciplines (C) That Geography alone is sufficient to understand environmental crises (D) That Political Science is the most important discipline for crisis management Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. The drought example shows that a single situation affects environment, economy, politics, society, and culture simultaneously, illustrating why Social Science is a group of related disciplines rather than a single subject. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1
18	Against the backdrop of which event did various political parties form an alliance as the Janata Party in 1977? (A) The Indo-Pak War of 1971 (B) The National Emergency (1975–1977) (C) The Anti-Defection Law of 1985 (D) The Economic Liberalisation of 1991 Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. In 1977, various political parties formed an alliance as the Janata Party against the backdrop of the National Emergency (1975–1977), forming the first coalition government at the national level. [Ch 7: Elections]	1
19	Which of the following is an example of a public good as described in the context of goods provided by the government for the benefit of all citizens? (A) Sanitisers during COVID-19 (B) Mangoes in the market (C) Streetlighting provided for public use (D) Wheat sold by farmers at market price Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Streetlighting provided for public use, because public goods are goods and services provided by the government for the benefit of all citizens, such as roads, bridges, public parks, and streetlighting.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 9: The Price Puzzle: What Drives the Market]</i>	
20	Which of the following correctly pairs each early civilisation with its associated river? (A) Harappan – Nile; Mesopotamian – Euphrates and Tigris; Egyptian – Sindhu; Chinese – Huang He (B) Harappan – Huang He; Mesopotamian – Nile; Egyptian – Sindhu and Sarasvatī; Chinese – Euphrates and Tigris (C) Harappan – Sindhu and Sarasvatī; Mesopotamian – Euphrates and Tigris; Egyptian – Nile; Chinese – Huang He (D) Harappan – Euphrates and Tigris; Mesopotamian – Sindhu and Sarasvatī; Egyptian – Huang He; Chinese – Nile Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The Harappan civilisation was along the Sindhu and Sarasvatī rivers, the Mesopotamian along the Euphrates and Tigris, the Egyptian along the Nile, and the Chinese in the Huang He basin. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	1
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	Describe the significance of Homo erectus in early human history. Answer: Homo erectus were the inventors of handaxes and cleavers. They were among the first to migrate out of Africa and gradually spread into Europe and Asia. They lived in the Eastern African Rift Valley about 2 million years ago. ► Why? This tests understanding of Homo erectus's key contributions—tool invention and migration—based on the source material. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	2
	OR What irrigation structure was built by Karikala Chola, and what does its continued use signify? Answer: The Grand Anicut (Kallanai) was built by Karikala Chola. It helped store and distribute water, supported agriculture, and encouraged settlement growth. Its continued use and repair by later rulers over many centuries, and its use even today, signify the lasting importance of Chola irrigation works. ► Why? The answer highlights the enduring legacy of Chola irrigation infrastructure and its long-term significance for agriculture. <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	
22	How is erosion different from weathering?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Weathering only breaks down rocks into smaller pieces without involving movement of the broken material. Erosion, on the other hand, is the process by which soil, rocks, and other surface materials are worn away and carried from one place to another by natural agents like water, wind, ice, or waves. Thus, erosion involves movement of broken material while weathering does not. ► Why? The answer compares the two concepts by highlighting the key distinction of material movement, which is explicitly stated in the source. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
	OR Why is media referred to as the 'fourth pillar of democracy'? Answer: Media is referred to as the 'fourth pillar of democracy' owing to its critical role in safeguarding people's voices and upholding democratic principles. Newspapers, news channels, and social media platforms raise issues concerning the public and contribute to their resolution through appropriate mechanisms. ► Why? This tests understanding of the role media plays in a democratic setup and the reason behind its designation as the fourth pillar. [Ch 6: Democracy]	
23	How does the ECI classify political parties, and what role does it play regarding election symbols? Answer: The ECI classifies political parties as recognised national or state/regional parties or registered-unrecognised parties. National and state parties are allotted election symbols. The ECI also acts as a quasi-judicial body in addressing disputes regarding recognition of political parties and allotment of symbols. ► Why? This question tests understanding of the ECI's role in party classification and symbol allotment. [Ch 7: Elections]	2
24	How does numismatics help historians understand a civilisation? Answer: Numismatics helps historians study the economy, chronology, rulers, trade, political boundaries, and culture of a civilisation through the metal content, inscriptions, and symbols found on coins, currency, or medals. ► Why? The source explains that numismatic analysis of coins reveals economic, political, and cultural information about past civilisations. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	2
25	How does Kālidāsa's Meghadūtam contribute to our understanding of the monsoon?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Kālidāsa, in Meghadūtam written around the 5th century CE, mentions the date of the onset of the monsoon over central India and also traces the path of monsoon clouds. ► Why? This tests knowledge of a historical literary reference to the monsoon mentioned in the source material. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	Explain the conditions that trigger avalanches on steep mountain slopes. Answer: Avalanches are caused by the sudden instability of snow on steep mountain slopes. Heavy snowfall within a short period adds extra weight to the snowpack, making it unstable, especially when it rests on weak or loosely bonded layers. A sudden rise in temperature can cause partial melting, reducing the friction that holds snow together. Strong winds may pile up snow unevenly, creating fragile layers. Natural disturbances such as earthquakes and vibrations, as well as human activities like skiing, trekking, or construction in mountainous areas, can trigger avalanches by disturbing the balance of snow-covered slopes. ► Why? The student must identify multiple triggers—snowfall, temperature, wind, natural disturbances, and human activities. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Explain how heavy snowfall and weak snow layers create instability. - Step 2: Describe how temperature rise and strong winds reduce friction and create fragile layers. - Step 3: Mention natural disturbances and human activities that trigger avalanches. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	3
	OR How does the verse from the Rig Veda reflect the idea of democratic traditions in early Indian thought? Answer: The verse from the Rig Veda (10.191.3), part of the Aikyamatyā Sūktam, reflects the idea of unity and collective decision-making. It states that their counsel is one and the same, their assembly is one, their mind is one, and their intention together is one. This suggests a shared guiding resolve and common purpose among the people. The idea that democracy has been a part of the Indian ethos since early times is reinforced by such references to assemblies and collective deliberation. The verse highlights the importance of consensus, shared intention, and unified participation, which are fundamental principles of democratic functioning even today. ► Why? The answer interprets the Rig Veda verse as presented in the source, connecting it to the concept of collective decision-making and democratic traditions in early India. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Identify the source of the verse (Rig Veda 10.191.3) - Step 2: Explain the meaning of unity in counsel, assembly, and mind - Step 3: Connect the verse to the idea that democracy was part of Indian ethos since early times	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 6: Democracy]	
27	Explain what humidity is and describe how it affects daily life and comfort levels. Answer: Humidity refers to the presence of water vapour in the air, creating moisture. When water evaporates from land and water bodies, it becomes water vapour, and high levels of this lead to humidity. As the air gets warmer, its capacity to hold water vapour increases, leading to higher humidity levels. This affects daily life in noticeable ways — on humid days, clothes take longer to dry and sweat evaporates more slowly, leaving us feeling very uncomfortable. The relationship between temperature and humidity means that warmer air can hold more moisture, making tropical regions particularly humid during summer months. ► Why? The answer defines humidity, explains its relationship with temperature, and describes its effects on daily comfort as stated in the source material. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define humidity as the presence of water vapour in the air. 2. Step 2: Explain that warmer air holds more water vapour, increasing humidity. 3. Step 3: Describe the effects on daily life — clothes drying slower, sweat evaporating slowly, and discomfort. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	3
	OR State any three criteria for recognising a political party as a National Party in India. Answer: A political party can be recognised as a National Party if it fulfils any one of the following conditions. First, it secures not less than 6% of valid votes polled in any four or more states in a General Election to the Lok Sabha or the Legislative Assembly, and in addition, wins four seats in the Lok Sabha from a single or more states. Second, it wins at least 2% of seats in the Lok Sabha, and the candidates are elected from at least three states. Third, it is recognised as a State Party in at least four states. Fulfilling any one of these conditions is sufficient for national recognition. ► Why? The source lists three distinct criteria for national party recognition, any one of which needs to be fulfilled. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: State the first criterion involving 6% votes in four states and four Lok Sabha seats 2. Step 2: State the second criterion involving 2% of Lok Sabha seats from three states 3. Step 3: State the third criterion of being recognised as a State Party in four states [Ch 7: Elections]	
28	Describe the impact of colonial rule on India's economy and the progress made after independence.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: For centuries, India was one of the world's leading economies and an important centre of trade, industry, and maritime activity. Colonial rule disrupted this progress, resulting in widespread poverty, recurrent famines, and the decline of traditional industries. After independence, India began the task of rebuilding its economy. In recent decades, the country has made significant progress through improvements in infrastructure, expansion of education and technology, reduction in poverty, and rising life expectancy. Yet important challenges remain, particularly in increasing incomes and ensuring that the benefits of growth reach all sections of society. ► Why? The answer traces the disruption caused by colonial rule and the post-independence progress and remaining challenges in India's economy. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Describe India's pre-colonial economic strength 2. Step 2: Explain how colonial rule disrupted progress causing poverty and decline 3. Step 3: Discuss post-independence progress and remaining challenges [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
29	Compare the roles and functions of the three assemblies—sabhā, samiti, and vidhata—in early Vedic polity. Answer: The Vedic texts, particularly the Rig Veda and Atharva Veda, refer to three assemblies. The sabhā was a smaller body composed of select elites that primarily served a judicial function. The samiti was a larger assembly focused on policy decisions and political affairs, representing the broader population. The vidhata was a popular gathering attended by members of the community (janas), functioning as a forum for discussions on warfare and other political matters. Together, these assemblies suggest that early Vedic governance involved forms of people's participation, with different bodies handling judicial, policy, and community-level political discussions. ► Why? The answer compares the three assemblies by size, composition, and function, showing how each contributed differently to Vedic governance. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the three assemblies mentioned in Vedic texts. 2. Step 2: Compare their composition and specific functions. 3. Step 3: Conclude by noting how together they suggest participatory governance. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	3
30	Compare the key characteristics and contributions of Homo habilis, Homo erectus, and Homo sapiens as described in the chapter. Answer: Homo habilis (handy man) lived in Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania and Kenya about 2–6 million years ago and made chopper stone tools. Homo erectus lived in the Eastern African Rift Valley about 2 million years ago, invented handaxes and cleavers, and were among the first to migrate out of Africa, spreading into Europe and Asia. Homo sapiens are the only human species living today and developed complex technologies, including the bow and arrow, microblade tools, symbolic communication, cave paintings, body decoration with pigments, and beads of stone, bone, and shell. While all ancestors were tool makers, only Homo sapiens developed such advanced technologies.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer compares three human ancestors by their time periods, locations, tools, and technological contributions as described in the source. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Describe Homo habilis — location, time period, and tools. 2. Step 2: Describe Homo erectus — location, time period, tools, and migration. 3. Step 3: Describe Homo sapiens — their complex technologies and status as the only surviving human species. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Explain the structure of the Earth's interior and describe how the movement of tectonic plates shapes the Earth's surface. Include the different types of plate boundaries and their associated landforms in your answer. Answer: The Earth is composed of three main layers: the crust, mantle, and core. The crust is the outermost layer, while the mantle beneath it is thick and hot. The innermost core is extremely hot and heavy. The crust and the upper part of the mantle form the lithosphere, which is broken into massive solid rock slabs called tectonic plates. These plates are of three types: continental, oceanic, and mixed. Beneath the lithosphere lies the semi-molten asthenosphere. Heat from the Earth's core causes molten material in the mantle to rise and cooler material to sink, creating convection currents that push and pull the tectonic plates. The movement of these plates shapes the Earth's surface at plate boundaries. At convergent boundaries, plates move towards each other. When continental plates collide, they form fold mountains like the Himalaya. When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate, the oceanic plate sinks, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. At divergent boundaries, plates move away from each other, allowing magma to rise and form new crust, creating features like mid-ocean ridges, such as the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. At transform boundaries, plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust, mainly causing earthquakes, such as along the San Andreas Fault. Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along these boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. ► Why? The Earth's internal structure drives plate tectonics through convection currents, and the interactions at plate boundaries create major landforms and natural disasters. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the Earth's three main layers and the formation of the lithosphere and asthenosphere. 2. Step 2: Explain the role of convection currents in the mantle causing the movement of tectonic plates. 3. Step 3: Describe the three types of plate boundaries: convergent, divergent, and transform. 4. Step 4: Provide examples of landforms and events associated with each boundary type (e.g., Himalaya, Mid-Atlantic Ridge, San Andreas Fault). 5. Step 5: Conclude with the significance of plate boundaries in the distribution of earthquakes and volcanoes, mentioning the Ring of Fire. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Describe the composition of the atmosphere and explain how the atmosphere regulates conditions on Earth, influencing weather and climate. Support your answer with relevant examples from the elements of weather discussed. Answer: The Earth's atmosphere is a blanket of air surrounding the Earth, pulled down by gravity. It is composed of a mixture of various gases. Nitrogen and oxygen are the two primary and most abundant gases, essential to life on Earth. Other gases present in lesser quantities include carbon dioxide, argon, helium, neon, krypton, xenon, ozone, and hydrogen. Besides gases, the atmosphere also contains water vapour, generally ranging from 0.1 per cent to 0.4 per cent, and tiny dust particles. Water vapour plays a significant role in cloud formation and precipitation. The composition of the atmosphere also varies with altitude. The atmosphere shields us from harmful radiation coming from the Sun, including ultraviolet radiation. It regulates the Earth's temperature by trapping some of the Sun's energy and preventing it from escaping back into space. It is a key component of the Earth's weather and climate systems, influencing factors such as temperature, humidity, and air pressure. Temperature varies between day and night and across seasons. An important factor affecting temperature distribution is insolation, which decreases from the equator towards the poles, causing temperature to decrease in the same direction. Humidity refers to the presence of water vapour in the air. As air gets warmer, its capacity to hold water vapour increases, leading to higher humidity. Precipitation occurs when the atmosphere becomes saturated with water vapour, which condenses and falls due to gravity in forms such as drizzle, rain, snow, sleet, and hail. Rain is the most common form and lowers the temperature of a place. Atmospheric pressure is the pressure exerted by the weight of air on the Earth's surface; it is highest at sea level and decreases with altitude. In areas with high temperatures, air heats up and rises, creating low pressure associated with cloudy skies and wet weather. In areas with lower temperatures, cold air sinks, creating high pressure associated with clear and sunny skies. Wind, the movement of air from high-pressure to low-pressure areas, further shapes weather conditions. ► Why? <i>The atmosphere's gas composition and its role in regulating temperature, radiation, and weather elements such as humidity, precipitation, and pressure are all interconnected systems that sustain life and shape climate.</i> ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: <i>Introduce the atmosphere as a blanket of air pulled down by gravity and describe its gas composition including nitrogen, oxygen, and other trace gases, water vapour, and dust particles.</i> 2. Step 2: <i>Explain how the atmosphere shields Earth from harmful radiation and regulates temperature by trapping the Sun's energy.</i> 3. Step 3: <i>Discuss the elements of weather — temperature (insolation), humidity, precipitation, and atmospheric pressure — and how each is influenced by the atmosphere.</i> 4. Step 4: <i>Explain the relationship between temperature, pressure, and wind, including how high and low pressure areas form and their associated weather.</i> 5. Step 5: <i>Conclude by summarising how all these elements together constitute the Earth's weather and climate systems.</i>	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
32	Discuss how the technological advancements, craft production, and economic integration during the Early Harappan period contributed to the emergence of urban centres of the Harappan civilisation. Support your answer with specific examples of crafts, water management, and trade systems. Answer: The Early Harappan period witnessed significant technological advancements and economic integration that laid the foundation for the emergence of urban centres of the Harappan civilisation. The Harappans were not merely agriculturists; they also practised a number of arts and crafts. Pottery was one of the major craft products that boosted their economy, with pottery remains from different regions showing unique styles in the shapes of vessels and their painted designs. Other crafts that showed gradual development included copper work, shell work, and the production of semi-precious stone beads. Evidence of Early Harappan bead production has been found from Harappa in Pakistan, Kunal in Haryana, and Datrana in Gujarat. The extensive use of graffiti on pottery and a few seals with geometric and simple animal motifs reported from early Harappan sites like Harappa, Rehman Dheri, and Kunal could be seen as forerunners to the script and inscribed seals of the Sindhu-Sarasvatī civilisation. In agriculture, the Early Harappans ploughed fields at Kalibangan showing horizontal and vertical furrows indicating double crop cultivation, like the seasonal Rabi and Kharif cultivation practised even today. Water management was another crucial advancement. Early Harappans in the foothills of Baluchistan built check dams known as 'gabarbands' across small streams to enhance irrigation. A much evolved form of these water management skills can be seen in the elaborate water harvesting system at Dholavira in Kachchh, where water from two nearby streams was diverted through dams and canals into a series of deep stone and mud-brick tanks, some cut deeper into the bedrock. The huge dockyard at Lothal, built entirely of burnt bricks, is another marvel of Harappan water management. The Harappans also had their own standard systems of weight and measurement, evident from their meticulously planned settlements and efficient interregional trade practices. They followed a binary multiple system (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, etc.) for weighing smaller units and used multiples of ten for larger denominations. Cubical stone weights have been reported from several sites. It was these combined technological advancements and economic integration that led to the emergence of the urban centres of the Harappan civilisation.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer traces how Early Harappan crafts, agriculture, water management, and standardised weights collectively created the economic and technological foundation for urbanisation. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the Early Harappan period as a foundation for urbanisation through technological and economic developments. 2. Step 2: Explain the major crafts — pottery, copper work, shell work, and bead production — with specific site examples like Harappa, Kunal, and Dattara. 3. Step 3: Describe agricultural advancements such as the ploughed fields at Kalibangan showing double crop cultivation. 4. Step 4: Detail the water management systems including gabarbands, Dholavira's interconnected tanks, and Lothal's dockyard. 5. Step 5: Discuss the standard weights and measures system (binary multiples and multiples of ten) and conclude how all these factors together led to the emergence of urban centres. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
	OR Describe the system of village governance in the Chola empire with special reference to the Uttaramerur inscription and the Kudavolai system. How did the village assemblies function as self-reliant institutions? Answer: The village was the smallest unit within a district in the Chola empire, and village councils or assemblies played an important role in settling disputes and managing local affairs. The village assemblies were responsible for all local administrative functions, including revenue collection, land management, irrigation, road construction, and record maintenance. They functioned as independent, self-reliant institutions and were not dependent on the government for patronage. The Uttaramerur inscription of Parantaka I (10th century) provides a vivid description of village governance. Located in the Vaikuntha Perumal Temple in Kanchipuram district of Tamil Nadu, these Tamil inscriptions furnish details about the functioning of village assemblies and inform us about the Kudavolai, or the 'ballot pot' system used in village elections. In this system, the names of eligible candidates were written on palm leaves and placed inside a large pot. During a public gathering, a young child was asked to draw the leaves, one by one, to select representatives for the village assembly and its various committees. To ensure fairness, the draw took place in full view of the community, often at a temple. The elected members were then divided into specialised committees called variyams, each entrusted with important village responsibilities, such as managing irrigation (the tank committee), administering justice, and collecting taxes. The inscription also specifies that candidates should have 'honest earnings' and be 'pure' of mind, showing the connection between ethical principles and governance. Thus, the Chola village assemblies demonstrated a well-organised, democratic, and ethically grounded system of local self-governance.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The question tests understanding of Chola-era village governance, the Kudavolai election system, and the self-reliant nature of village assemblies as described in the Uttaramerur inscription. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Introduce the role of village assemblies in the Chola empire and their administrative functions. - Step 2: Describe the Uttaramerur inscription of Parantaka I — its location and significance. - Step 3: Explain the Kudavolai or ballot pot system in detail — palm leaves, pot, child drawing leaves, public gathering. - Step 4: Discuss the specialised committees (variyaams) and their responsibilities such as irrigation, justice, and tax collection. - Step 5: Conclude by highlighting how village assemblies functioned as independent, self-reliant institutions with ethical requirements for candidates. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
33	Discuss the causes and consequences of the National Emergency imposed in India in 1975–77. How did the lifting of the Emergency and the subsequent general elections demonstrate the resilience of Indian democracy? Answer: The National Emergency of 1975–77 was one of the major challenges to democracy in India. In the early 1970s, public dissatisfaction with the government led by Indira Gandhi was growing due to rising unemployment, inflation, and allegations of misgovernance, which led to widespread protests. In June 1975, a National Emergency was imposed by the government on the grounds of internal disturbance. During this period, a majority of Fundamental Rights were suspended, the press was censored, and numerous political leaders and activists were arrested. Democratic institutions came under severe strain, and citizens' freedom was restricted. Mass movements led by Jayaprakash Narayan—a political leader and socialist thinker popularly known as Lok Nayak—mobilised students and citizens, especially in Bihar and Gujarat. The Emergency was lifted in 1977, and general elections were held, allowing people to express their will through the ballot. The defeat of the ruling government demonstrated the strength of Indian democracy and highlighted the importance of constitutional safeguards, civil liberties, and active citizen participation in protecting democratic values. This period highlighted both the vulnerabilities and the resilience of democratic institutions in India, showing that while democracy can come under threat, the collective will of the people expressed through elections can restore democratic norms.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The Emergency illustrates how internal crises can threaten democratic institutions, while its aftermath shows how elections and citizen participation can restore democratic governance. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Introduce the Emergency of 1975–77 as a major challenge to Indian democracy and mention the growing public dissatisfaction with the Indira Gandhi government. - Step 2: Explain the causes — rising unemployment, inflation, allegations of misgovernance, and widespread protests. - Step 3: Describe what happened during the Emergency — suspension of Fundamental Rights, press censorship, arrests of political leaders and activists, and strain on democratic institutions. - Step 4: Mention the role of Jayaprakash Narayan (Lok Nayak) in mobilising students and citizens in Bihar and Gujarat. - Step 5: Conclude with the lifting of the Emergency in 1977, the general elections, the defeat of the ruling government, and how this demonstrated the resilience of Indian democracy and the importance of constitutional safeguards and active citizen participation. [Ch 6: Democracy]	
34	Discuss the various sources used by historians to understand the social realities of the past. How do different historical traditions, including the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and modern historiography, contribute to the study of history? Answer: History is the study of the human past, helping societies understand people's experiences, values, and changes over time. Different historical traditions have used various methods to preserve cultural memory. In Bharat, the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition shares historical information through stories, giving cultural meaning to events and reinforcing enduring ideals and values. In contrast, modern historiography increasingly relies on empirical evidence and scientific tools like human genetics, carbon-14 dating, and archaeology to establish timelines. To understand social realities, historians draw on a wide range of sources. Literary sources include travelogues, memoirs, correspondence, genealogical records, folklore, and oral traditions. Archaeological sources consist of material remains such as monuments, architectural structures, excavated sites, artefacts, and art like sculptures and paintings, which often require scientific instruments and laboratory testing for analysis. Additionally, epigraphic sources provide direct evidence through texts, decrees, or records inscribed on durable materials like stone, metal plates, or rock surfaces, revealing information about past events, rulers, and administration. Numismatic sources, comprising coins, currency, or medals, help historians study the economy, chronology, trade, and political boundaries through the metal content, inscriptions, and symbols on coins. By combining these diverse traditions and sources, history not only documents what happened but also transmits cultural values from one generation to the next.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer explains the diverse methods and sources—literary, archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic—used in history writing, contrasting traditional storytelling with modern empirical methods. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce history as the study of the human past and the need to understand social realities. 2. Step 2: Contrast the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition's storytelling approach with modern historiography's reliance on empirical evidence and scientific tools. 3. Step 3: Detail the literary sources such as travelogues, memoirs, and oral traditions. 4. Step 4: Explain archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic sources, providing specific examples of each from the material. 5. Step 5: Conclude by summarizing how these combined sources help transmit cultural values and establish timelines. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	

Section E
Attempt 3 out of 4.

35	Case Study: Weathering, Erosion, and Human Livelihoods In a region with rocky terrain, plant roots grow into cracks in rocks, gradually splitting them apart. Temperature changes further break the rocks into smaller pieces, but the broken material does not move. Meanwhile, in nearby dry and sandy areas, wind carries away loose soil, and in coastal areas, sea waves wear away the land along the shore. For farmers in this region, the removal of fertile topsoil has led to lower crop yields. Those living near rivers and coasts face land being washed away, damaging houses and roads. Construction and mining activities have become risky as the land has become unstable. Even tourism and fishing suffer as beaches and fertile lands are degraded. (i) Identify the process by which plant roots split rocks apart and name its type. (ii) Distinguish between weathering and erosion based on the movement of material. (iii) Identify the two types of erosion mentioned in the passage and explain how each affects farmers and coastal residents respectively. (iv) Why does erosion pose a safety risk specifically in construction and mining? Answer: (i) The process is weathering, and the type is biological weathering, which is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms. (ii) Weathering only breaks down rocks into smaller pieces and does not involve movement of the broken material. Erosion involves both the wearing away and the carrying or movement of the broken material from one place to another by natural agents. (iii) Wind erosion (common in dry and sandy areas) removes fertile topsoil, leading to lower crop yields for farmers. Coastal erosion (where sea waves wear away land along the shore) washes away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property for coastal residents. (iv) Erosion destabilises land, which poses safety risks in construction and mining because the ground becomes unstable and unsafe for these activities.	5
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	► Why? i) The process is weathering, and the type is biological weathering, which is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms. ii) Weathering only breaks down rocks into smaller pieces and does not involve movement of the broken material. Erosion involves both the wearing away and the carrying or movement of the broken material from one place to another by natural agents. iii) Wind erosion (common in dry and sandy areas) removes fertile topsoil, leading to lower crop yields for farmers. Coastal erosion (where sea waves wear away land along the shore) washes away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property for coastal residents. iv) Erosion destabilises land, which poses safety risks in construction and mining because the ground becomes unstable and unsafe for these activities. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
	OR Case Study: Early Human Ancestors and Stone Tools Around 3.3 million years ago, one of our earliest ancestors made the first stone tools, marking the beginning of 'human behaviour'. These ancestors came to be known as 'hominins' or tool makers. The tools they created functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. Homo habilis, the 'handy man', lived in Africa around 2-6 million years ago and made chopper stone tools. Their successors, Homo erectus, invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa, spreading into Europe and Asia. While all human ancestors were tool makers, it was Homo sapiens who developed complex technologies, including the bow and arrow, microblade tools, and symbolic communication through cave paintings and beads. (i) Why are early humans referred to as 'hominins'? (ii) What is meant by the term 'extra-corporal limbs' in the context of stone tools? (iii) Compare the contributions of Homo habilis and Homo erectus to early human technology. How did Homo sapiens further advance upon these developments? (iv) Why is the making of stone tools considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' rather than animal behaviour? Answer: (i) Early humans are referred to as 'hominins' or tool makers because they made the earliest stone tools, which marked the beginning of 'human behaviour' as opposed to animal behaviour, since animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. (ii) Stone tools are called 'extra-corporal limbs' because they functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. (iii) Homo habilis made chopper stone tools and lived in Africa 2-6 million years ago. Homo erectus invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa. While all ancestors were tool makers, Homo sapiens developed complex technologies including the bow and arrow, parallel-sided blade and microblade tools, symbolic communication, cave paintings, and beads of stone, bone, and shell. (iv) The making of stone tools is considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' because animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. This cognitive ability to create and use tools distinguished early humans from animals.	



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	► Why? i) Early humans are referred to as 'hominins' or tool makers because they made the earliest stone tools, which marked the beginning of 'human behaviour' as opposed to animal behaviour, since animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. ii) Stone tools are called 'extra-corporal limbs' because they functioned as extensions of the human body, helping people perform tasks they could not accomplish with their hands alone. iii) Homo habilis made chopper stone tools and lived in Africa 2-6 million years ago. Homo erectus invented handaxes and cleavers and were among the first to migrate out of Africa. While all ancestors were tool makers, Homo sapiens developed complex technologies including the bow and arrow, parallel-sided blade and microblade tools, symbolic communication, cave paintings, and beads of stone, bone, and shell. iv) The making of stone tools is considered the beginning of 'human behaviour' because animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. This cognitive ability to create and use tools distinguished early humans from animals. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
36	Case Study: Layers of the Atmosphere and Climatic Conditions A group of students studied the atmosphere and its layers. They learned that the troposphere and mesosphere are the only layers where temperature decreases with altitude. Above the troposphere lies the stratosphere, which extends up to 50 kilometres and contains the ozone layer that filters the Sun's harmful ultraviolet radiation. The mesosphere extends up to 80 kilometres, where most meteorites burn up. In the thermosphere, temperature rises rapidly as gas molecules absorb X-rays and short-wave ultraviolet radiation. The thermosphere also helps radio transmission by reflecting radio waves back to Earth. Auroras, caused by solar wind interacting with atmospheric gases near the magnetic poles, occur here. The students also explored how weather refers to hour-to-hour and day-to-day conditions, while climate is the average weather over thirty years or more. (i) Why is the stratosphere considered ideal for flying aeroplanes? (ii) What is the difference between weather and climate? (iii) Explain how auroras are formed and why they occur in the thermosphere. (iv) In which two layers of the atmosphere does temperature decrease with increasing altitude? Answer: (i) The stratosphere is ideal for flying aeroplanes because it is free of clouds and other weather disturbances. (ii) Weather refers to the hour-to-hour and day-to-day conditions of the atmosphere, while climate refers to the sum total of weather conditions and variations over a large area for an extended period of time, usually thirty years or more. (iii) Auroras are formed when the solar wind (charged particles emitted by the Sun) reaches the Earth's atmosphere and is directed towards the magnetic poles. As these particles interact with different atmospheric gases, each gas glows with a particular colour. This phenomenon occurs in the thermosphere, where temperature rises rapidly with increasing altitude as gas molecules absorb X-rays and short-wave ultraviolet radiation of the Sun. (iv) Temperature decreases with increasing altitude only in the troposphere and the mesosphere.	5



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	► Why? i) The stratosphere is ideal for flying aeroplanes because it is free of clouds and other weather disturbances. ii) Weather refers to the hour-to-hour and day-to-day conditions of the atmosphere, while climate refers to the sum total of weather conditions and variations over a large area for an extended period of time, usually thirty years or more. iii) Auroras are formed when the solar wind (charged particles emitted by the Sun) reaches the Earth's atmosphere and is directed towards the magnetic poles. As these particles interact with different atmospheric gases, each gas glows with a particular colour. This phenomenon occurs in the thermosphere, where temperature rises rapidly with increasing altitude as gas molecules absorb X-rays and short-wave ultraviolet radiation of the Sun. iv) Temperature decreases with increasing altitude only in the troposphere and the mesosphere. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
37	Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? Answer: (i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. (ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. (iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. (iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	

